LOOP & BLOOM

# Easy Criss-Cross Loop Yarn Baby Blanket — Beginner No-Hook Pattern

This soft Criss-Cross Baby Blanket is made with pre-looped blanket yarn, so no crochet hook is required. The fabric is built by crossing pairs of loops and pulling fresh working-yarn loops through them from back to front, creating a plush diagonal texture across the blanket. The pattern is rated Easy and is a good choice for beginners who want to try loop-yarn construction without traditional crochet stitches. The finished blanket measures approximately 32 × 40 inches and works well as a cozy baby blanket, stroller blanket, or nursery layer.



## PROJECT INFORMATION

**DIFFICULTY**
Easy

**TIME**
A few hours, depending on experience with loop

**YARN**
Bernat Alize Blanket-EZ pre-looped yarn, 6.4

**HOOK**
No crochet hook required

**FINISHED SIZE**
Approximately 32 × 40 inches [81.5 × 101.5 cm]

## About This Pattern

This blanket uses pre-looped yarn rather than conventional crochet stitches. Instead of forming stitches with a crochet hook, you work directly with the prepared loops using your fingers.

The criss-cross texture comes from crossing neighboring stitches before pulling fresh loops through them. Rows are worked back and forth in opposite directions while the same side of the blanket remains facing you. The work is never physically turned.

One important feature of the construction is the offset between Rows 2 and 3. Row 2 begins by skipping one stitch and ends with one stitch unworked. Row 3 then uses that unworked stitch as part of its first crossed pair. This alternating placement helps the diagonal texture continue evenly.

The bulky pre-looped yarn creates a thick, plush fabric suitable for a baby blanket. Because the stitch-making process requires no hook, the project is also approachable for crafters who are new to yarn work or who prefer finger-loop techniques.

## Materials

- Bernat Alize Blanket-EZ pre-looped yarn
- Cream (37013), 4 balls
- Scissors
- The original sample uses four balls of Bernat Alize Blanket-EZ in Cream.

## Abbreviations

- st — Stitch
- sts — Stitches
- rep — Repeat

## Instructions

## STEP 1 — PREPARE THE FOUNDATION LOOPS

Pattern: Count 50 loops from the yarn for the foundation row.

Arrange the loops so they are all facing upward, with the yarn end positioned at the far left.

Keep the working yarn behind the foundation loops throughout the project.

Step-by-step: Lay the loop yarn on a flat surface and count exactly 50 loops. These loops form the width of the blanket.

Make sure every loop is upright and easy to see before beginning. The loose yarn end should be on the far left.

The working yarn remains behind the stitches throughout the pattern. Whenever a new loop is pulled through an existing stitch, bring it from the back of the work toward the front.

## ROW 2 — BEGIN THE CRISS-CROSS TEXTURE

Pattern: Work from right to left.

Cross the 50th foundation loop in front of the 49th loop.

Pull the next loop from the working yarn from behind through the 49th loop.

Pull the following working-yarn loop from behind through the 50th loop.

Continue across the row by crossing the next pair of foundation loops.

For each crossed pair, hold the loops in position and pull one working-yarn loop from back to front through each foundation loop.

Repeat across the entire row.

Do not turn the work.

Step-by-step: Begin at the right-hand edge of the 50 foundation loops.

Take the last loop and cross it in front of the loop directly beside it. Keep the two loops crossed while you bring fresh loops from the working yarn through them.

Pull the first fresh loop through the loop that is now behind, then pull another fresh loop through the other crossed loop.

Move to the next pair and repeat the same process.

This pairing creates the diagonal criss-cross appearance. When the row is complete, keep the right side facing you instead of turning the blanket.

Stitch count: 50 stitches.

## ROW 3 — WORK BACK ACROSS THE BLANKET

Pattern: Work from left to right.

Skip the first stitch of the row just completed.

Cross the 2nd stitch in front of the 3rd stitch.

Holding the crossed stitches in place, pull the next working-yarn loop from behind through the 3rd stitch.

Pull the following working-yarn loop from behind through the 2nd stitch.

Continue by crossing the next 2 stitches.

For each crossed pair, pull one new working-yarn loop from behind through each stitch.

Repeat to the last stitch.

Leave the last stitch unworked.

Do not turn the work.

Step-by-step: For this row, move in the opposite direction, from left to right, but keep the same side of the blanket facing you.

The first stitch is intentionally skipped.

Cross the next two stitches, then bring fresh loops through them from the working yarn behind the blanket.

Continue pairing and crossing stitches across the row.

When only one stitch remains at the opposite edge, leave it unworked. This unworked stitch is important because it becomes part of the first crossed pair in Row 3.

## ROW 4 — CROSS BACK IN THE OPPOSITE DIRECTION

Pattern: Work from right to left.

Cross the unworked stitch from Row 2 in front of the 2nd stitch.

Hold the two stitches crossed.

Pull the next working-yarn loop from behind through the 2nd stitch.

Pull the following working-yarn loop from behind through the first stitch.

Continue across the row by crossing the next 2 stitches.

For each crossed pair, pull one fresh working-yarn loop from behind through each stitch.

Repeat to the end of the row.

Do not turn the work.

## ROW 5 — BEGINS WITH THE STITCH THAT WAS DELIBERATELY LEFT UNWORKED AT THE END OF ROW 2.

Pattern: Cross that edge stitch over the stitch beside it. Hold the pair in position while pulling two new working-yarn loops through from back to front.

Continue crossing pairs as you move from right to left.

The alternating direction of Rows 2 and 3 keeps the criss-cross texture balanced across the blanket.

## STEP 6 — REPEAT THE PATTERN

Pattern: Repeat Rows 2 and 3 until the blanket measures approximately 40 inches [101.5 cm] in length.

Finish after completing a Row 2.

Step-by-step: Continue alternating Row 2 and Row 3 without turning the blanket.

One row travels from left to right and the next travels from right to left. The right side of the blanket remains facing you throughout.

Measure the blanket occasionally rather than relying on a specific number of rows.

Stop when the blanket is approximately 40 inches long, making sure your final completed row is a Row 2.

## Finishing

Work the bind-off in the same direction as the final row.

Pull the 2nd stitch through the 1st stitch.

Then pull the 3rd stitch through the 2nd stitch.

Pull the 4th stitch through the 3rd stitch.

Continue in the same manner across the entire edge, passing each new stitch through the previous stitch.

At the end, cut the yarn strand at the base of the remaining loop to create a yarn tail.

Tie the tail securely and weave in the loose ends.

## Important Notes

- Keep the right side facing you. — The blanket is not turned after each row. Instead, alternate the direction in which you work across the fabric.
- Keep the working yarn behind the stitches. — Fresh loops should come from behind the blanket and be pulled through existing stitches toward the front.
- Keep all loops upright. — Twisted loops can interrupt the criss-cross texture. Straighten each loop before crossing or pulling a new loop through it.
- Do not work the final stitch of Row 2. — That last stitch is intentionally left unworked. It becomes the first part of the crossed pair at the beginning of Row 3.
- Maintain 50 foundation loops. — The original blanket begins with exactly 50 loops and produces an approximate width of 32 inches with the specified yarn.
- Finish on Row 2. — Continue alternating Rows 2 and 3 until the blanket reaches approximately 40 inches, then stop after completing Row 2 before binding off.

## Variations

### DIFFERENT COLOR

Use another shade of the same Bernat Alize Blanket-EZ yarn to coordinate the blanket with a nursery, seasonal palette, or gift theme.

Keeping the same yarn type preserves the loop size and finished construction.

### LONGER BLANKET

For a longer blanket, continue alternating Rows 2 and 3 beyond the original 40-inch measurement.

When you reach your preferred length, finish after a Row 2 before working the bind-off.

### COORDINATED BLANKET SET

Use the same loop yarn color to make additional simple nursery accessories or smaller coordinating pieces.

Keeping the same yarn gives the projects a consistent plush texture and appearance.

## Common Mistakes

### TURNING THE BLANKET AFTER A ROW

The criss-cross texture may begin facing different directions, and the working yarn may move to the wrong side of the fabric.

How to fix it: Keep the right side facing you throughout the entire project.

Instead of turning the blanket, simply change your working direction from right to left or left to right as instructed.

### PULLING NEW LOOPS FROM THE FRONT

The texture may look inconsistent and the fresh loops may sit on the wrong side of the blanket.

How to fix it: Keep the working yarn behind the stitches.

Every fresh loop should travel from the back of the work through the existing stitch toward you.

### FORGETTING TO CROSS THE STITCHES

The blanket will develop ordinary vertical loop columns instead of the intended diagonal criss-cross texture.

How to fix it: Before pulling any new loops through a pair, make sure the two existing stitches are crossed in the direction specified for that row.

Hold the crossed pair in position while pulling the fresh loops through.

### WORKING THE LAST STITCH OF ROW 2

Row 3 will no longer have the required unworked edge stitch to begin the next offset crossed pair.

How to fix it: On every Row 2, stop when one stitch remains and leave that final stitch untouched.

Use it at the beginning of Row 3.

### TWISTING THE FOUNDATION LOOPS

Some stitches may appear distorted or face backward, creating uneven sections in the finished texture.

How to fix it: Before starting Row 1, arrange all 50 foundation loops so they are facing upward.

Check each pair as you work and untwist loops before pulling fresh yarn through them.

## FAQ

### DO I NEED A CROCHET HOOK FOR THIS BLANKET?

No. The blanket is made with pre-looped yarn, and the stitches are formed with your fingers.

The working loops are pulled directly through the existing loops without a traditional crochet hook.

### WHY DO I NEVER TURN THE BLANKET?

The pattern is designed so the right side stays facing you at all times.

Instead of turning the fabric, you alternate the working direction from one row to the next.

## WHY IS ONE STITCH LEFT UNWORKED IN ROW 2?

That stitch creates the offset required for the next criss-cross row.

At the beginning of Row 3, the unworked edge stitch is crossed in front of the next stitch and incorporated into the pattern.

## HOW WIDE IS THE BLANKET?

With 50 foundation loops and the specified Bernat Alize Blanket-EZ yarn, the finished blanket is approximately 32 inches [81.5 cm] wide.

Yarn tension and handling may cause small differences in the finished measurement.

## HOW DO I KNOW WHEN TO STOP REPEATING THE ROWS?

Continue alternating Rows 2 and 3 until the blanket measures approximately 40 inches [101.5 cm] long.

The final repeated row should be Row 2.

## CAN I USE ORDINARY YARN INSTEAD OF PRE-LOOPED YARN?

Not with these instructions as written.

The construction depends on evenly spaced manufactured loops in the yarn. Standard yarn would require a different stitch-making method and a rewritten pattern.

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